

COMPLETE NARRATIVE EDITION

Print and separate before play.

This complete edition contains 46 PDF pages. The ranges below are **physical PDF positions**, not the archive folios retained within the case.

Player packet: PDF positions 3-32 (30 pages).

Optional hints: PDF positions 33-37 (5 pages).

Sealed solution: PDF positions 39-46 (8 pages).

For the simplest setup, print the separate Player, Hints, and Sealed Solution PDFs. If using this file, separate the protected sections using these ranges before distributing the player packet. The sections start on fresh duplex sheets.

Print US Letter at 100%, or A4 with Fit; grayscale is sufficient. Read the player instructions for the archive folios, story leaves, and investigation. All characters and records are fictional.

PRINT SETUP

The player file begins next.

Keep the hints and solution separate before anyone starts reading. This reverse protects the first player sheet when printing duplex.

a printable investigation

Eleanor Hart Is Missing

At six, her mother set a place for supper.
At eight, a telegram said she had gone away.

Her family kept a name out of the records.
Eleanor found it.
Then Eleanor disappeared.

CINCINNATI / 19 JUNE 1912

Read the documents. Reconstruct the family.
Find what happened to Eleanor.

1-4 investigators / pencil + paper / fully offline

Start on page 2. Keep hints (27-30) and solutions (31-36) separate until needed.

READ FIRST

Read the people. Test the papers.

Print the Player PDF in full. This edition contains 30 pages, including its cover and interleaved story. Use US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%; on A4, use Fit. Grayscale is sufficient. Single-sided lets you spread the records out; duplex uses the long edge. Keep the separate hints and sealed solution away from the player stack.

Follow the printed archive folios. Existing page references mean the numbers labeled ARCHIVE in the footers, which remain stable. New story leaves use S0-S3. They make the PDF positions different from the archive numbers. Use the bookmarks or clickable catalog to find a page on screen.

Begin with the opening scene and brief. Read EH01-EH03 and choose your next record through archive folio 4. Each later scene names the records to read first. In a nonlinear search, return to that scene after you have examined its records; scene order does not prove a connection.

Let the records carry the proof. The new scenes dramatize the people around these papers. They are fictional narrative, not additional archival exhibits. A character can be mistaken. Names, dates, parents, addresses, source references, and the supplied rules establish the case; sympathy does not.

Make your case. Use archive folios 21-26. Cite exhibit codes and exact fields, test alternatives, and leave unsupported matters open. Everyone investigates; no host, internet, cutting, or outside research is required. Use hints only when needed; open the solution after answering all final questions.

The original investigation has sixteen exhibits and six final deductions.

THE STORY CONTINUES

The supper kept warm

Before the opening brief

Margaret had left the warming oven open. By morning there was nothing in it worth saving, but shutting the door seemed too much like agreeing that the meal was over.

Henry stood beside the table with his cap crushed between his hands. He was old enough to work at the works and young enough to look at his mother whenever something had to be decided. She wanted him to say something useful. Instead he asked whether she had slept.

"Have you?" she said.

He shook his head. She put a cup in front of him. It was easier to be angry while doing something kind.

The telegram lay beside Eleanor's place. Margaret had read it until the capital letters ceased to resemble her daughter's voice. Gone away. Do not look. She could imagine Eleanor going somewhere without permission. That was different from believing she had sent this message. Her daughter was twenty-five; Margaret knew she could not make a disappearance impossible merely by calling it unlike her.

"James says she went," Henry said.

"I know what James says."

He looked down. She heard what she had done: made him choose between an absent sister and the brother he would have to face at work. She touched his sleeve.

"Tell them what you know. Not what will make me feel better."

When George arrived, his expression was the careful one he used for estate business. He put his papers on the table, then moved them away from Eleanor's plate. Margaret watched that small correction. For sixteen months, since Samuel's death, George had been the person who knew what had to be signed and what could wait. This morning she needed him to admit that he might not know.

"She asked you to listen," she said.

"I intended to."

"Then start with what she left here."

George reached for the portfolio of copies. Margaret did not let go at once. Some part of her still wished Eleanor had left the old registers alone. She hated herself for the wish, and hated that it had survived the night.

Henry drew his chair closer. Nobody ate. The papers were spread between people who loved the same missing woman and no longer knew whether they could trust the same brother.

A place at the table

Wednesday, 19 June 1912 / before the family meeting

At six o'clock yesterday evening, Margaret Hart set a place for her daughter. At seven she put Eleanor's supper in the warming oven. At twelve minutes past eight, a boy brought a telegram. The message said Eleanor had gone away. Her mother did not believe it.

For a week Eleanor had been copying names from old registers. Yesterday she took a portfolio to Hart Tool & Pattern Works. She did not come home. Her father, Samuel, has been dead for sixteen months. At ten this morning his brother George is due to settle the ownership of the business. Eleanor had asked him to hear what she had found first.

Person	Place in the inquiry
Eleanor Mae Hart	Missing; 25; daughter of Samuel and Margaret.
James Hart	Her brother; acting manager of the works.
Henry Hart	Her younger brother; apprentice at the works.
George Hart	Her uncle; Samuel's brother and executor.
Margaret Hart	Her mother; reported the disappearance.

Your task: reconstruct the family, explain the disappearance, and tell George where to search. The records name other people you will need to identify for yourself.

Treat this as a closed case file: all required evidence is supplied. Statements can be mistaken or dishonest; compare them with independent records. No unseen accomplice or undisclosed fact is needed to solve the case.

Inside the file

Code	Exhibit	Page
EH01	Missing-person inquiry	5
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EH16	Paper recovered in the east yard	20

Work pages: family (21), timeline (22), possible explanations (23), final answers (24-25), evidence log (26).
Optional hints: 27-30. Protected solution: 31-36.

All characters, businesses and individual records are fictional. These are purpose-designed reading exhibits, not scans of authentic records. Census fields are selectively reproduced. The will is a fictional instrument. No print defect, typeface or punctuation difference is a clue.

Missing-person inquiry

Cincinnati / report opened 19 June 1912, 7.30 a.m.

Subject	Details
Name	Eleanor Mae Hart / age 25
Residence	1634 Lincoln Avenue, Walnut Hills
Destination	Hart Tool & Pattern Works / 418 Eastern Avenue

Mrs. Margaret Hart reports that her daughter left home at about 4.30 yesterday afternoon, Tuesday, 18 June. She carried a brown paper portfolio tied with blue cotton tape. She said she was taking family papers to the works and would be home for supper at six.

She wore a pale blouse, dark skirt and a straw hat with a black band. She took neither a travelling bag nor a change of clothes. A telegram was delivered at 8.12 p.m. Mrs. Hart cannot explain it and has retained the envelope.

JAMES HART / BROTHER / ACTING MANAGER

"I saw her near the front office at five. She said she was going away. She left by the river gate. I have not seen her since."

HENRY HART / BROTHER / APPRENTICE

"I was out with a delivery. Nell said she would show Uncle George something at tomorrow's meeting. She would not say what."

GEORGE HART / UNCLE / EXECUTOR

"A family meeting was arranged for ten this morning. Eleanor asked me not to settle the works before I had heard her. She sounded excited, not frightened."

Papers from Eleanor's writing desk supplied by Mrs. Hart. No conclusion as to a voluntary departure has been reached.

Household schedule

Thirteenth census / census date: 15 April 1910

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

1634 Lincoln Avenue / dwelling 47 / family 52

Name	Relation	Age	Marriage	Years
Samuel Hart	Head	56	M2	28
Margaret Hart	Wife	50	M1	28
Eleanor Hart	Daughter	23	Single	-
James Hart	Son	20	Single	-
Henry Hart	Son	15	Single	-

Name	Occupation / industry
Samuel Hart	Manufacturer / tool and pattern works
Margaret Hart	None
Eleanor Hart	None
James Hart	Machinist / tool works
Henry Hart	None; attended school

Margaret: children born, 3; children living, 3.

Samuel: home owned, mortgaged.

All five residents and their parents born Ohio.

Key: M1 = first marriage; M2 = second marriage. Years = completed years of the present marriage. A dash means the field does not apply. Selected household fields copied by Eleanor; all residents shown.

Marriage-register extracts

Hamilton County / copies made 14 June 1912

ENTRY 94 / VOLUME 31 / PAGE 94

14 September 1876

Samuel Hart, aged 22, of Cincinnati
and **Ellen Byrne**, aged 20, of Cincinnati.

Bride's father: John Byrne.

Marriage solemnized on the date above.

Entered: 16 September 1876.

ENTRY 187 / VOLUME 42 / PAGE 187

19 May 1881

Samuel Hart, aged 27, of Cincinnati
and **Margaret Cole**, aged 21, of Cincinnati.

Marriage solemnized on the date above.

Entered: 21 May 1881.

Both extracts copied on 14 June 1912.

E. M. Hart

Two extracts retained among Eleanor's family papers.

Parish register

St. Anne's Parish / Cincinnati / extracts supplied 15 June 1912

BAPTISMS / ENTRY 63

Francis Hart

Born: **3 July 1877.**

Baptized: 22 July 1877.

Father: Samuel Hart, pattern maker.

Mother: Ellen Hart, formerly Byrne.

Residence: Cincinnati.

Sponsors: Michael Byrne and Catherine Byrne.

BURIALS / ENTRY 41

Ellen Hart, formerly Byrne

Wife of Samuel Hart. Aged 23 years.

Died: **4 November 1879.**

Buried: 6 November 1879.

Survived by husband Samuel and son Francis.

Brother named in the entry: Michael Byrne, of Kilgour Street.

Supplied at the request of Miss Eleanor Hart.

A. Fenwick, parish clerk

Spare extracts retained on Eleanor's writing desk.

THE STORY CONTINUES

The first wife's name

After EH03-EH04 / Documents 03-04

Margaret read the marriage entry without moving her lips. Samuel's name was familiar enough to make the rest of the line seem a mistake.

Ellen Byrne.

There were dates she could test, a parish to ask, a child to trace. Those were the useful things. The useless thing was the sudden desire to remember every occasion on which Samuel might have told her and had not.

George waited. That irritated her more than a question would have done.

"You needn't watch me," she said. "I can read it."

"I wasn't certain you would want to."

She looked at him then. Eleanor's notebook would preserve her own awkward response to the discovery: asking whether her daughter had eaten. Margaret had meant to keep one ordinary thing from falling apart. She could see how it might have sounded like asking Eleanor to stop.

"Would wanting change the entry?"

George turned the page so the burial extract lay beside the marriage. The formal lines offered no account of what kind of wife Ellen had been. They did not say whether she laughed loudly, whether she worried over money, whether someone had sat beside her at the end. Margaret had first experienced her as an intrusion. Here was the record of her death.

She was ashamed of the order in which her feelings had arrived.

"I don't want my children made smaller by this," she said.

George did not answer quickly. "We have to find out what this is before we decide what it takes from anyone."

Margaret smoothed the edge of the copy. It had not been torn. She was smoothing something that did not need mending.

Eleanor had met the same names in the same narrow columns and kept going. For the first time that morning, her mother understood the work as more than a daughter upsetting a house. Someone had once occupied these lines. Somebody had been left to carry the memory of her.

That still did not tell Margaret whom to trust. It gave her a reason to turn the next page.

Household schedule

Tenth census / census date: 1 June 1880

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

204 Kilgour Street / dwelling 18 / family 21

Name	Relation to head	Age	Condition
Michael Byrne	Head	28	Married
Catherine Byrne	Wife	25	Married
Francis Hart	Nephew	2	Single

Name	Occupation	Born
Michael Byrne	Millwright	Ohio
Catherine Byrne	Keeping house	Ohio
Francis Hart	-	Ohio

Michael and Catherine: both parents born Ireland.

Francis: both parents born Ohio.

Copy includes all residents returned for this household.

E. M. Hart / 14 June 1912

Selected fields copied from the household schedule. Ages are as of the census date, not the date Eleanor copied the entry.

Household schedule

Twelfth census / census date: 1 June 1900

Ohio / Hamilton County / Cincinnati

204 Kilgour Street / dwelling 41 / family 44

Name	Relation	Birth	Age
Michael Byrne	Head	Feb 1852	48
Catherine Byrne	Wife	Jun 1854	45
Frank Byrne	Nephew	Jul 1877	22

Name	Occupation	Marital status
Michael Byrne	Millwright	Married, 24 years
Catherine Byrne	-	Married, 24 years
Frank Byrne	Machinist	Single

Catherine: children born, 0; children living, 0.

All three residents born Ohio.

Michael and Catherine: parents born Ireland.

Frank: parents born Ohio.

House owned, free of mortgage.

Copy includes all residents returned for this household.

E. M. Hart / 14 June 1912

Selected household fields. Age is age at last birthday on the census date.

Private correspondence

Letter addressed to Samuel Hart / retained among his private papers

204 Kilgour Street
9 July 1905

Samuel,

Frank turned twenty-eight on Monday. Catherine made the seed cake he likes, though he says he is too old for birthdays.

You asked what name he uses at the shop. It is Frank Byrne, as it has been since his schooldays. In Ellen's parish book he is Francis Hart. He is the same boy you brought to us after my sister died. A different name did not give him a different father.

He knows who you are. I have never told him otherwise. He has asked why you can pass him in the street and inquire after his work, yet never ask him into your house.

I cannot answer that for you. Your younger children are not to blame for knowing nothing of him. Neither is Frank to blame for being born before them.

Your money has arrived each quarter. I have kept the receipts, as you requested. But he earns his own living now. If there is something you wish him to have, put it plainly in writing and tell him yourself.

Michael

Estate of Samuel Hart

Will extract and executor's memorandum

Will dated: 2 November 1909.

Samuel Hart died: 14 February 1911.

Will admitted to probate: 21 March 1911.

Executor: George Hart, brother of the deceased.

EXTRACT / THE WORKS

"I give my interest in Hart Tool & Pattern Works, together with its machinery, tools, patterns, stock and goodwill, to my eldest surviving son. This gift is not conditional upon his present employment in the works or residence in my household. Until delivery of the business to that son, my executor shall retain its control."

MEMORANDUM / 17 JUNE 1912

James manages the works under my temporary authority. The works have not yet been distributed. Samuel told me years ago that the child of his first marriage had died. I had understood James to be the eldest surviving son and prepared an acknowledgment of delivery on that basis.

Eleanor has asked that no delivery be made before she is heard. I have arranged for the family to meet here at ten on Wednesday, 19 June. I shall examine what she brings before proceeding. Her copies of the family records are to be checked against the originals.

G. Hart / Executor

The case asks you to interpret the words of this fictional will using the supplied family records. No external inheritance rules are required.

THE STORY CONTINUES

What the payments could not buy

After EH07-EH08 / Documents 07-08

Henry stopped at the seed cake. Of all the things in Michael Byrne's letter, that was the detail he read twice.

"Twenty-eight," he said. "And she still made it."

Margaret knew what he was trying to imagine. A birthday in a house none of them had visited. A man who could be passed in the street and asked about his work. A father's money arriving on time while the invitation never arrived at all.

"We weren't told," Henry said.

"No."

He seemed to need more than that. She could not give him innocence on behalf of every adult in the family. She could only leave room for the question.

George laid his executor's memorandum beside the letter. Its orderly sentences looked different now. He had written down what Samuel told him; he had prepared to act upon it. Whatever the investigation ultimately established, repeating a trusted man's account had not made the account independent evidence.

"James has been doing the work," Henry said. He sounded almost apologetic. "That part is true."

"It may be," George said. "The gift has words of its own."

Margaret disliked the coldness of that answer until she considered its alternative: each of them editing the will to reward the person already nearest to them. James's work did not vanish because another record existed. Neither could another person be made to vanish because James's work mattered.

Michael's letter did not ask the younger children to apologize for being born. It asked Samuel to do something plain. Tell him yourself. Margaret found the simplicity of it unbearable.

Henry moved the letter out from under the estate paper.

"Don't cover it," he said.

She left it where he put it. They still needed the records that connected one name to another, and evidence that reached the present day. Affection was not a certificate. But the certificates were no longer an exercise in tidying a pedigree. Whatever name the investigation established, there was a person at the other end who had once waited to be asked inside.

Eleanor's notebook

17-18 June 1912 / retained on her writing desk

MONDAY / 17 JUNE

Uncle George will wait until Wednesday. He says names on a family tree are not enough: bring the papers that connect them.

Mother does not remember ever hearing Ellen's name. She looked at the marriage copy for a long time, then asked whether I had eaten.

I mean to write to Mr. Byrne when I know how to begin. What does one say to a person who has been kept outside one's life for twenty-five years?

TUESDAY / 18 JUNE / BEFORE LEAVING

James called at four. He says Father's old receipt book is still downstairs at the works, beside the pearwood patterns. It may show the payments Michael mentioned. He will meet me at the front office at five and fetch it with me.

He was very particular that I should come alone. He says Mother has been upset enough.

Take the copies, not Michael's letter. Leave this book here. Home for supper at six. Tomorrow I shall put the whole thing before George, even if James thinks it unkind.

A name ought not to be a thing a family can take away.

Bell & Mercer

Private lending / correspondence retained at the works

15 JUNE 1912 / TO MR. JAMES HART

Sir,

Your personal advance of **\$1,200** falls due on **20 June**. You represented that the works would shortly be delivered to you from your father's estate.

We have received no evidence of that delivery. Unless the executor confirms your ownership, we will require repayment in money. Your position as acting manager does not satisfy our request.

W. Mercer

REPLY RETAINED / 17 JUNE 1912

Mr. Mercer,

The acknowledgment is prepared for Wednesday morning. I expect to have it in hand before noon. You shall receive it that day. I cannot repay the advance in cash.

James Hart

Personal correspondence. The advance is James's private debt.

THE STORY CONTINUES

A reason is not a permission

After EH09-EH10 / Documents 09-10

The amount in the lender's letter drew Henry's eye before anything else. He had never held twelve hundred dollars. Written beside the due date, it made James's confidence about Wednesday look less like confidence.

"He must have thought he could put it right," Henry said.

Margaret heard an old family habit in the sentence: take the frightening thing, find a gentler name for it, and hope the new name will hold.

"We don't know what he did," she answered.

Henry looked relieved. She made herself finish.

"That means we must find out. It doesn't mean we may stop."

George read Eleanor's notebook again. She had intended to bring copies, protect the original letter, go home for supper, and put the matter before him. Even in private she was thinking about what papers would survive being carried through the works. Her care was practical. She had not known she would need someone else to follow it.

Margaret paused at the words about James thinking it unkind. She knew how effective that accusation could be inside a family. Cruelty sounded like shouting. Unkindness could be laid at the feet of the quiet person asking a question.

"I wanted her to leave it for a day," she said. "I wanted one supper without these names in it."

Neither man offered to absolve her. For once she was grateful. There was a difference between wishing a daughter would stop asking and making her unable to speak. There was also work to do before anyone could say what had happened at the works.

George drew the attendance reply and office records toward him. They had been made for different purposes by people with different things to notice. A debt could explain pressure. A frightened family could supply a theory. Neither could place a man at a particular door.

Henry opened his hands and let the cap rest on the table. "Then we follow it all the way," he said.

Margaret nodded. She wanted Eleanor home. She was beginning to understand that she could not make that wish conditional on what bringing her home might reveal.

Attendance reply

Ohio Valley Machinists Association / annual meeting / Pittsburgh

TUESDAY / 18 JUNE 1912

Afternoon practical examination / Room B

Delegate	Town	Entered	Released
Charles R. Nolan	Louisville	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.
Frank Byrne	Cincinnati	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.
Arthur M. Keene	Pittsburgh	4.45 p.m.	6.15 p.m.

Each man worked at his assigned bench throughout the examination. No delegate left the room between the times entered above. I called the roll at the opening and close and supervised the benches throughout.

Frank Byrne gave his home address as **204 Kilgour Street, Cincinnati**. His signature appears on the original attendance leaf.

I attest to his presence during the whole interval, not merely to his registration for the meeting.

Thomas W. Reed

Examination steward

Reply received by George Hart at 8.05 a.m., 19 June 1912. For this reply, **all attendance times above are stated in Cincinnati time**. Signed original to follow by post.

Works office book

Hart Tool & Pattern Works / 18-19 June 1912

Key	Issued to	Out	Returned
A3 / front office	Ada Pike	8.00 a.m.	6.30 p.m.
B2 / counting room	George Hart	4.45 p.m.	6.20 p.m.
C7 / lower store	James Hart	4.50 p.m.	Not returned

Private message accounts

J17 / James Hart

G04 / George Hart

H09 / Henry Hart

These charges are paid by the named person, not the works.

CLERK'S MEMORANDUM / 19 JUNE, 7.50 A.M.

I balanced the estate accounts with Mr. George Hart in the counting room from 4.50 until 6.10 yesterday. He remained with me throughout. I saw him return B2 at 6.20.

Henry Hart returned the signed delivery receipt from Larkin's yard. Their receiving clerk records that Henry was helping him unload continuously from 4.45 until 5.45 p.m. The original receipt is attached to the office book.

C7 has not been returned. Its duplicate is still in the sealed envelope in the cash box; I checked it this morning. The seal bears my initials and has not been broken since I sealed it on **11 June, after the replacement lock was fitted.**

Ada Pike

Statement of Thomas Vale

Watchman / statement taken 19 June 1912, 8.12 a.m.

At ten past five yesterday I was in the passage by the lower stair. A young woman in a straw hat with a black band came through carrying a brown packet tied with blue tape. I saw her go down with a man from the office. I saw his back and cannot swear who he was.

At about twenty past five Mr. James Hart came up those stairs alone. I know him well. He told me the young lady had gone out by the river gate. He said the lower store was empty and I need not try its door on my rounds.

I heard three knocks from below at half past six. When I stopped, they came again. I took them for a loose pipe and went on. I did not see the young lady leave the building.

At ten minutes past eight this morning I heard the same knocking. No machinery was running. I went down and found the lower door locked. I could get no words through it. I asked Miss Pike for C7 and learned it was still out.

I should have tried the door last night. Mr. Hart had told me there was no one there.

Thomas Vale

Statement recorded at the works. The witness distinguishes the man he recognized from the man whose face he did not see.

River & City Telegraph

Delivered message and local dispatch memorandum

Accepted: Cincinnati office / 18 June 1912 / 7.48 p.m.

Delivered: 8.12 p.m.

To: Mrs. Margaret Hart / 1634 Lincoln Avenue / Cincinnati

GONE TO DAYTON FOR A FEW DAYS
DO NOT LOOK FOR ME
WILL WRITE
ELEANOR

DISPATCH MEMORANDUM / SUPPLIED 19 JUNE

The message was brought in an envelope by a works messenger. He did not claim to be Miss Hart. The signature in the message was copied as supplied; we did not see the person whose name it bore.

Charge instruction enclosed: **Hart works private account J17.**

Receipt 4186. Fee entered against J17.

PAUL FINCH / MESSENGER

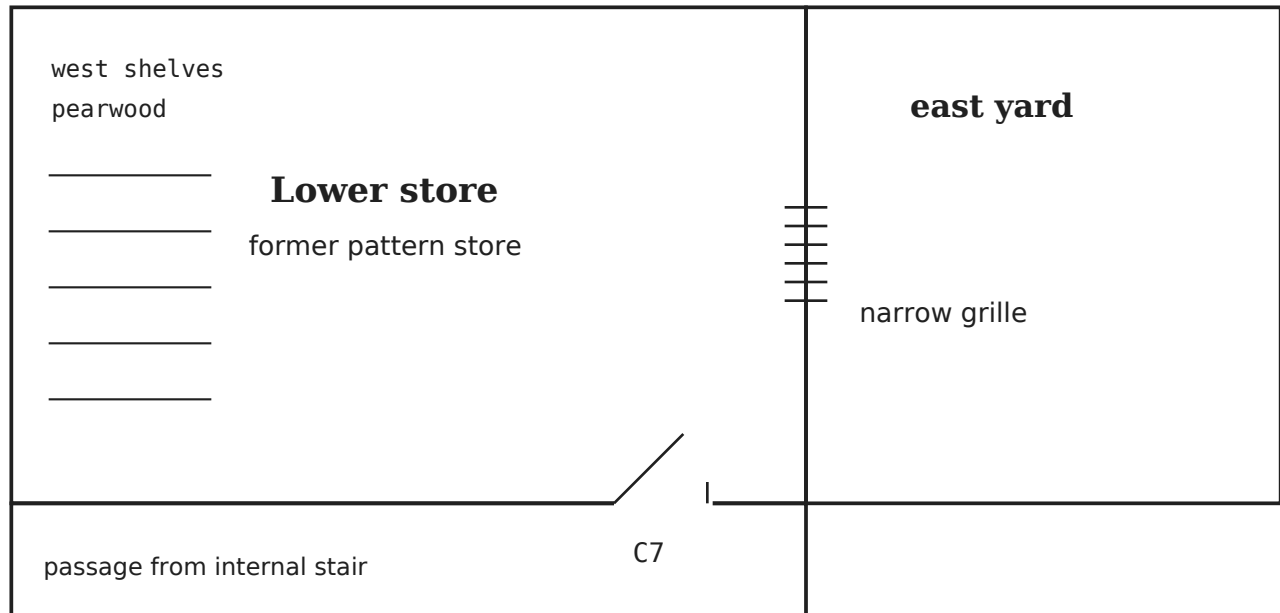
"Mr. James Hart handed me the envelope at the works at half past seven. He told me to have it sent at once and put the charge on his own account. I took it directly to the office without opening it."

Recorded by A. Ellis, telegraph clerk.

The telegram was accepted in Cincinnati; it was not received from a Dayton office.

Lower-floor survey

418 Eastern Avenue / 11 June 1912 / not to scale



north is above / east is right

SERVICE NOTE / C7

Lower store, formerly pattern store. Pearwood patterns remain on the west shelves. Door reached only by the internal stair and passage. The river gate is on the main floor; there is no passage from this room to that gate.

Fitted replacement outside lock. Key marked C7, with one duplicate. No other key supplied. There is no inside handle or release. Door must be locked with the key; it does not lock merely by closing.

Ventilation opening to yard retained. Narrow grille admits air and small papers, not a person. Opening can be reached from the shelves. No window or other exit from the store.

R. Moss / Locksmith

East-yard recovery

19 June 1912 / 8.15 a.m. / works yard

Watchman Vale found this folded paper beneath a low grille in the east yard wall. Its reverse is a receipted invoice from the works. Mrs. Hart identifies the writing as Eleanor's. The pencil strokes are heavy; the last line is deeply scored into the paper.

As the paper was handed to the officer, Miss Pike was bringing the sealed duplicate key from the office. George Hart waited at the head of the lower stair. The door had not yet been opened.

TEXT OF THE NOTE

If this comes out where someone can see it, please fetch Uncle George.

I was brought down for Father's book. The door was locked while I was looking at the shelves. It was done with the key. I heard it turn.

I have been here all night. I can see morning through the narrow opening. There is paper here and a carpenter's pencil. I have been knocking, but the machines stopped long ago and nobody comes.

He said I should come out when the acknowledgment was signed. Do not let George sign it.

Eleanor

Please do not let him sign it.

Reconstruct the family

Use solid lines for proven links and dotted lines for working theories.

shared parent _____	
first spouse / marriage date _____	later spouse / marriage date _____
child / name later used _____	children / ages or dates _____

WHO RAISED THE CHILD?

Name the adults and explain how they were related to the child.

Which exhibits prove that the two names belong to one person?

Follow the last afternoon

Write the event, its source, and whether it is witnessed, reported or inferred.

Date / time	Event or whereabouts	Exhibit
18 June / before five		
5.00-5.10 p.m.		
5.10-5.20 p.m.		
6.10-6.30 p.m.		
7.30-8.12 p.m.		
19 June / morning		
Next action		

A person's own claim is not independent confirmation. Attendance times in EH11 have already been converted to Cincinnati time.

Test competing explanations

Motive alone is not a case. Record evidence for and against each explanation.

Person / theory	Reason or access	Evidence against / unresolved
-----------------	------------------	-------------------------------

James Hart		
------------	--	--

Henry Hart		
------------	--	--

George Hart		
-------------	--	--

Another person named in the records		
-------------------------------------	--	--

Eleanor left voluntarily		
--------------------------	--	--

Which explanation accounts for the family papers, the appointment, the locked door and the telegram together?

Your final reconstruction

Answer in your own words. Give exhibit codes for every conclusion.

01

The family before Margaret

Who was Samuel's first wife? Who was their child? Cite the record that proves parentage.

02

The name that changed

Who is Frank Byrne, and how is he related to Eleanor? Connect the 1880 child to the 1900 adult and the person documented in 1912.

03

The ownership of the works

Who fits the beneficiary description in the will? Why must George stop the prepared acknowledgment?

Your final reconstruction

Your answer must explain the evidence, not merely name a suspect.

04

The disappearance

Who is responsible, why act now, and how was Eleanor confined? Include her plans and at least one independent record of access or conduct.

05

The telegram

Who arranged it? What does the dispatch record prove, and what does the signature fail to prove?

06

The search instruction

Give the address, room, route and key. Explain why the door could not simply lock itself and what supports searching for Eleanor alive.

Keep a useful detail separate from the conclusion you draw from it.

Finish all six answers before opening the solution. If you are stuck, turn only to the hint section and cover the hints you do not need.

OPTIONAL HELP

Use one hint at a time.

Return to the records as soon as a hint gives you a next step. The original hint levels and exhibit references remain unchanged in this edition.

If a scene has made you certain about somebody, ask which record supports that certainty. Caring about a person, distrusting them, or finding their explanation plausible is not a substitute for a link in the evidence.

The story can leave a motive complicated while the record answers a factual question. You are allowed to reach a firm identification and still disagree about the person involved.

The following pages retain their original hint folios. Read progressively. Keep the separate sealed solution closed until you have committed your answer.

Optional hints

A nudge, when you need one.

Keep this section separate from the case file.
It contains progressively stronger help.

PAGE 28

First nudges. Read only the numbered item for the question you are working on.

PAGE 29

Where to look. These point to the relevant records.

PAGE 30

Final nudges. These make the crucial connections explicit.

Cover the other items with a spare sheet. Hints have no score penalty. Return to the evidence after each one.

The solution is in a different section, beginning on page 31.

First nudges

1 / family

Compare the marriage notation for Samuel and Margaret in the 1910 household. Look for a child born between the two marriage dates.

2 / identity

A surname may change while an address, birth month and relationship to a household remain the same. Find a document that makes the identification explicit.

3 / the works

Use the exact beneficiary description. Running the business and inheriting it are different facts.

4 / disappearance

Compare Eleanor's own plans with the account given after she vanished. Which person has a deadline, a relevant key and conduct that supports concealment?

5 / telegram

Read the office's account of how the message arrived. A name at the end of a message is not proof of authorship.

6 / search

Connect the grille, the shelving and the door. Then look for a way to open that door without depending on its current key holder.

Where to look

1 / family

EH02 records M2 for Samuel. EH03 gives two marriages. EH04 identifies a child and both parents.

2 / identity

Compare EH05 and EH06: household head, address, relationship and age. EH07 explains the changed name; EH11 places the adult in 1912.

3 / the works

Read EH08 beside EH04, EH02 and EH11. Is the older son still alive? Has the business already been delivered?

4 / disappearance

Use EH09 for the appointment, EH10 for the financial deadline, EH12 for key possession and whereabouts, and EH13 for what the watchman saw.

5 / telegram

EH14 names the messenger's source and gives account J17. EH12 identifies the account holder. Compare the message with EH09 and EH16.

6 / search

EH15 describes the room and lock. EH12 gives the duplicate's location. EH13 and EH16 provide evidence from the morning of 19 June.

Final nudges

1 / family

Ellen Byrne was Samuel's first wife. The parish entry names their son Francis. Margaret married Samuel after Ellen died.

2 / identity

Frank Byrne is Francis Hart. Michael explicitly says so. Frank and Eleanor share Samuel as father; their mothers differ.

3 / the works

The will names the eldest surviving son, not James by name. Frank is older than James and alive in 1912. George's preparation rests on Samuel's false account.

4 / disappearance

James needs Wednesday's acknowledgment before his debt falls due Thursday. He arranged the visit, took C7 and came upstairs alone. He then discouraged a search and supplied a departure message.

5 / telegram

Finch says James gave him the message. J17 is James's private account. The clerk did not see Eleanor. The location alone would not disprove a planned journey.

6 / search

The former pattern store is below the main floor at 418 Eastern Avenue. Use the internal stair and passage, and the sealed C7 duplicate in the office cash box. The note says Eleanor survived the night.

SEALED SOLUTION

Stop here until you commit.

This file reveals the investigation, the identities, and the ending. Keep it separate from the player packet.

Before continuing, write your conclusion, cite the records that support it, and name an uncertainty the file does not resolve.

Read the evidence-cited solution first. The expanded aftermath follows the original ending. It develops the human consequences; it does not supply a clue needed to solve the case.

A blank reverse follows this cover so the first answer starts on a fresh sheet when this file is printed on both sides.

SPOILER BARRIER

The answer is overleaf.

Keep this file closed until your written reconstruction is complete.

The family reconstructed

1 / ELLEN BYRNE AND FRANCIS HART

Samuel married Ellen Byrne on 14 September 1876 (EH03). EH04 names Samuel and Ellen as parents of Francis Hart, born 3 July 1877. Ellen died on 4 November 1879. Samuel married Margaret Cole on 19 May 1881 (EH03). Samuel's M2 and Margaret's M1 in EH02 fit this sequence.

2 / FRANK IS FRANCIS, ELEANOR'S HALF-BROTHER

Francis is Michael Byrne's two-year-old nephew in 1880 (EH05). In 1900, a nephew called Frank Byrne, born July 1877, lives with the same adults at 204 Kilgour Street (EH06). EH07 explicitly identifies him as the same boy, Samuel's son by Michael's sister Ellen. EH04 establishes that Michael is Ellen's brother. The census matches support the connection; the letter confirms it.

EH11 links the adult Frank in 1912 to the same Cincinnati address. Frank and Eleanor share Samuel as father but have different mothers. Michael and Catherine raised Frank; these records do not require a legal adoption.

3 / FRANK FITS THE GIFT IN THE WILL

The gift is to Samuel's eldest surviving son, with no requirement to work at the business or live in his household (EH08). Frank was born in 1877 and is alive in 1912 (EH04, EH11). James was twenty in 1910 (EH02), so is younger. On these records Frank is the eldest surviving son.

George believed the first child had died because Samuel told him so. His memorandum reports that belief; it does not prove the death. The works have not yet been delivered. George should stop the acknowledgment and verify Eleanor's records (EH08).

Complete answers identify the people, explain the name change, and apply the actual will wording. Matching surnames or running the works is insufficient.

Why Eleanor did not return

4 / JAMES HART

The supported reconstruction is that James took Eleanor to the lower store to look for Samuel's receipt book, stepped outside, and deliberately locked her in. He wanted to keep her from presenting the family evidence before George signed the acknowledgment.

Part of the case	Evidence
Immediate pressure	EH10: \$1,200 due 20 June. James cannot repay in cash and promises Wednesday's acknowledgment. EH08: Frank's existence threatens James's expected ownership.
Arranged meeting	EH09: James asks Eleanor to come alone at five for the receipt book. Eleanor plans supper at six and disclosure the next morning. EH01 independently records her supper plan.
Access and conduct	EH12: James takes C7 at 4.50 and does not return it. EH13: he comes up the lower stairs alone at about 5.20, says Eleanor left, and tells Vale not to try the store.
Deliberate confinement	EH15: the door locks only with a key and has no inside release. EH16: Eleanor heard the key and was told she would stay until the acknowledgment was signed.

Other explanations: EH11 places Frank under continuous supervision in Pittsburgh. EH12 places George with Ada Pike and Henry unloading elsewhere during 5.10-5.20. These weaken alternatives; the positive evidence against James carries the conclusion.

The watchman did not identify the descending man. Do not turn that uncertainty into an eyewitness identification. His later recognition of James is explicit.

The message and the room

5 / JAMES ARRANGED THE TELEGRAM

EH14 says Paul Finch received the envelope directly from James at 7.30 p.m. The enclosed charge instruction used J17, which EH12 identifies as James's private account. The office copied the supplied signature and did not see Eleanor.

That proves James arranged dispatch. The signature does not establish Eleanor's authorship or consent. Acceptance in Cincinnati does not, by itself, disprove a plan to travel to Dayton. Read with her intended return (EH09) and note from confinement (EH16), the telegram supports the attempt to make her disappearance appear voluntary.

6 / SEARCH THE FORMER PATTERN STORE

Go to **418 Eastern Avenue, Hart Tool & Pattern Works**. Take the internal stair and passage to the lower store, formerly the pattern store. Use **C7** or the duplicate in the **sealed envelope in the office cash box** (EH12, EH15).

The narrow east-yard grille, pearwood shelving and internal route identify the room (EH09, EH15, EH16). There is no route from that room to the river gate and no other exit. The lock requires a key, so an accidental closing cannot explain the confinement (EH15).

Eleanor's note, identified by Margaret as her writing, says she survived the night and saw morning (EH16). Repeated knocking at 8.10 a.m. supports an immediate search (EH13). Opening the door is required to confirm her present condition.

Complete search answer: address + room + internal route + C7 duplicate + deliberate locking + morning evidence.

The sequence that fits

When	What the records support
17 June	George agrees to hear Eleanor before distribution. James tells the lender he expects the acknowledgment on Wednesday. EH08-EH10.
18 June / 4.00-5.00	James arranges the solitary visit. Eleanor leaves home at about 4.30, intending supper at six. James takes C7 at 4.50. EH01, EH09, EH12.
5.10-5.20	Vale sees a woman matching Eleanor descend with a man. James comes up alone at about 5.20 and tells him the lower store is empty. Confinement during this interval is the reconstruction. EH13, EH16.
6.30	Vale hears repeated knocks but accepts the explanation that no one is below. EH13.
7.30-8.12	James gives Finch the message; the office accepts it at 7.48 and delivers it at 8.12. EH14.
19 June / 7.50-8.15	The duplicate seal is checked. The attendance reply arrives. Vale hears knocking, finds the door locked and then finds Eleanor's note. EH11-EH13, EH16.
Before 10.00	Stop the acknowledgment. Open the lower store with the duplicate. Verify the family evidence before proceeding with the estate. EH08, EH12, EH15-EH16.

The exact moment the key turned is inferred from the combined evidence, not supplied as a witnessed timestamp.

A place for one more

George broke the seal on the envelope himself. Ada Pike watched him take out the duplicate key, then followed him to the stair.

At the lower door, he called Eleanor's name. The answer was so faint that he put his ear to the iron before he tried the lock.

She was sitting beside the shelves, her portfolio on her knees. The blue tape had been tied again. There was dust on her skirt and a carpenter's pencil in her hand. She asked whether he had signed.

He said he had not.

James had brought her down to find the receipts. When she bent over the books, he stepped outside and turned the key. Through the door he told her it would only be until morning. Once George had signed, he said, there would be no purpose in upsetting everyone.

"He told me I could still have a brother," she said. "He meant I should choose which one."

The police found the working key in James's coat. The meeting did not take place. George retained the estate papers for examination, and Margaret took Eleanor home.

Two days later, Frank Byrne came to Lincoln Avenue. He stood on the step with his hat in both hands, as though he had called at a customer's house.

Eleanor opened the door. She had thought of several things to say and remembered none of them. From the dining room her mother asked whether their guest would stay for supper.

"There is a place," Eleanor told him.

AFTER THE CASE

The chair was only a beginning

After the original solution and ending

At supper, Frank did not take Samuel's chair. Nobody had asked him to, but Margaret noticed the care with which he chose another.

She had imagined this meeting as an arrival: open the door, set another place, and the exclusion would at last be over. Instead she found herself wondering whether to pass him the bread before Henry, whether using Francis would sound intimate or merely ignorant, whether an apology would ask a guest to comfort his hosts.

Eleanor had been rescued. That fact deserved all the relief the house could hold. It did not make the other facts easier. James was still her son. Frank was still a stranger to her. Samuel, who had arranged so much of their ignorance, could answer none of their questions.

"Michael calls me Frank," their guest said when George hesitated over his name.

Margaret was grateful for the instruction. "Frank, then."

Henry asked about the practical examination. It was a real question, about work he wanted to understand, and Frank answered it. For a few minutes nobody needed to discuss the estate. Eleanor listened with her hands below the edge of the table. When a door sounded in the passage, she looked up too quickly. Her mother saw it and kept her own hands still.

Later, George spoke of checking the originals. He said plainly that the works had not been delivered to James. He did not ask Frank to admire his caution now, after the years in which he had believed Samuel's account.

"I should have checked what I was told," he said.

Frank regarded him for a moment. "You can check it now."

It was less than forgiveness and more useful than reassurance.

When Margaret began, "If we had known," Eleanor touched the folded napkin beside her plate. Her mother stopped. She had almost offered an impossible history in place of the evening they actually had.

"I don't know what you would like us to call this," Margaret said instead.

"Supper," Frank answered. There was a small kindness in it, and a boundary.

After he had gone, Eleanor refused to have her portfolio put away in Samuel's desk. She asked for it in her own room. Margaret carried it upstairs and left it where her daughter could reach it.

The investigation had established the relationship, the confinement, the false message, and the place to search. It had not established that a new brother could replace an old one, or that a meal could repay thirty-four years. George still had papers to examine. The family had something smaller for this evening: the right names spoken aloud, and an invitation that had finally been made.